



SIGNAL

WINTER 2026 ISSUE



Vern Eide
EMPLOYEE OWNED

Our Vision: To enhance the lives of our employees, customers, and the community
Our Mission: We Deliver Dreams

THE SIGNAL'S WINTER FEATURED VEHICLE

Article/Layout/Photos by Tristan Lake



The Story Behind the Ride

Some cars are cool because of what they are, while some are priceless because of the stories they carry. Tyler Swanger's 1984 Oldsmobile Hurst/Olds checks both boxes: being a unique piece of automotive history, and a personal time capsule packed with family memories.

Tyler (Mitsu Sales Manager) has been part of the Vern Eide team since 2013, and just a year into working here, he found himself tracking down a car that had been part of his life long before he ever worked at Vern Eide. In 2014, after connecting online with a seller in Omaha, Tyler purchased his Hurst/Olds nearly identical to one his father owned throughout Tyler's childhood. (That original car met its end after a teenage mishap)

Over a decade later, Tyler's Hurst/Olds is still very much a part of daily life, family memories, and Vern Eide events.



TYLER SWANGER'S 1984 HURST/OLDS



A Rare Slice of Oldsmobile History

The 1984 Hurst/Olds marks the final chapter of Oldsmobile's long-running partnership with Hurst Performance, a legendary name from the muscle car era.

Only about 3,500 were produced for 1984, making them instantly recognizable by their silver-over-black paint scheme with red pinstriping, which is the inverse of the black-over-silver look used in 1983.

Under the hood you'll find Oldsmobile's 307 cubic-inch V8, paired with one of the car's most unusual features, and one of Tyler's favorites, the Hurst Lightning Rod shifter. Instead of a single gear selector, the Lightning Rods use three chrome levers mounted side by side, giving drivers more hands-on control over an automatic transmission.

A Car Meant to Be Driven

One of Tyler's Hurst/Olds most impressive details is its mileage: over 400,000 original miles, all while remaining largely bone stock. Aside from a small bumper modification courtesy of the back of a fellow employee's pickup in the parking lot a couple years ago.

Looking Ahead

In 2019, it was the car Tyler and his wife, Sabrina, rode in on their wedding day. These days, it makes frequent family trips to B&G Milkyway, so much so that his kids simply know it as "the ice cream car".

Tyler's plans for the Hurst/Olds are simple: keep caring for it, keep driving it, and keep sharing it.

He also hopes to someday add a 1983 Hurst/Olds to his collection to complete the set alongside the 1984 models owned by both him and his dad.

Among all the vehicles Tyler owns, this Hurst/Olds stands out for its unique family history and the memories tied to it, serving as a reminder that the best cars are the ones that become part of life along the way.



*Let us
know
about your
ride for a
possible
future issue
of the
Signal!*



Operation Christmas

It began as a simple act of kindness. In 1989, Our CEO Jim Lake and his wife Barb started Operation Christmas – adopting a family and shopping for them. That small, caring tradition is now a powerful legacy.

For Christmas 2025, the mission stayed the same, but the impact has grown beyond what anyone imagined. In just two weeks, Vern Eide Employees raised nearly \$25,000 – an all-time record. With those funds, our Vern Eide family made the biggest difference we've ever made.



From Left to Right: Tom Borchard, Jeff Roskens, Jessica Reinhart, Mary Wiese, Trace Stump, Andy Graning, Tristan Lake, Chase Sabers, Mariella Lurch, Jodi Casey, Shannon Fenning, Jeff Reynolds, and Shyla Burgers

The largest portion of the gift bought presents for around 500 kids. Those presents were delivered to the Sharing Christmas store, where moms and dads could choose special items for their kids. The giving didn't stop there: Vern Eide employees purchased \$10,000 worth of diapers and distributed 500 Hy-Vee gift cards so local families could put a holiday meal on the table.

Moved by the spirit of giving they witnessed, Jim and Barb donated \$15,000 to the Union Gospel Mission and another \$15,000 to the Bishop Dudley House. Those donations were used to buy gifts for the children in their care, spreading our community's generosity even further. Thanks to all who helped with this important undertaking.

Thanks for the memories

Colin Fitzsimons

While 2026 holds exciting things for Vern Eide Acura, a man who helped get that store to where it is today is taking retirement for a spin. Colin Fitzsimons started with the Vern Eide Acura family in 2010. In his time as an Acura Gold Master Sales Consultant, Colin helped hundreds of customers find their dream cars.



Vern Eide Acura sent Colin off with a goodbye party that allowed dozens of friends and co-workers to say thanks for the memories. And since Colin is an avid golfer, he received a new set of clubs to take out on the links. In addition to more golf, he and his wife plan to travel more, including finding a place to hang their hats overseas.



New Year, New You

An estimated one-third of Americans make New Year's Resolutions, and most give up on the promises they made to themselves by February. Many of those broken resolutions are health-related. Vern Eide has tools that can help employees live their best lives 365 days a year.

That includes the Eide Excelerate program, which tracks the number of steps a person takes a quarter; those results can result in a cash reward. Employees can also take advantage of the onsite gym located on the Mitsubishi campus.

Full-time employees can receive a free gym membership at participating Great Life facilities. Have questions? Contact Camille or Jodi in HR or scan the QR Code.



Vern Eide Christmas Party

It was Christmas in January as 330 Vern Eide employees gathered Sunday, January 11, to celebrate a great 2025. Attendees enjoyed watching football, playing darts, playing video games, and competing in a chili cook-off, with 11 employees turning up the heat in an effort to prove they make the best chili. Honda service advisor Rob Cypher took first place; Nick Cramer (Motoplex GM) placed second; and Mary Weise (VVI) finished third.



The grand prize winner in the Vern Eide Christmas drawing was Natasha Walberg (accounting), who won a \$4000 travel voucher. Vern Eide Mitsubishi sales consultant Hope Yount won a Honda NAVI-Automatic Mini Motorcycle. Thanks to the party planners for another successful event.

Continuing to Grow

2025 was once again a year of growth at Vern Eide. Vern Eide Marine acquired Soo Sports and combined the two locations into one at the Vern Eide Marine store at 4501 E. Arrowhead Parkway. After lots of discussion, planning, paperwork, and remodeling, Vern Eide has enlarged its Arrowhead campus.

Vern Eide Rentals and REM Construction can now be found in the old Liberty National Bank building at 4619 E Arrowhead Parkway. Right next door, in the strip mall that once housed a casino and grocery store, Vern Eide IT, VVI (Vision Video Interactive) are now calling part of that space home. An expanded Certified Auto Glass can also be found there.

Eide Effect Heroes November 2025



Maggie Saugstad
Director of Community Relations & Marketing
(vvi)

"Her grace, love, and compassion are always on display, and she fully embodies the standard of service to others established by Vern in 1965. It is my honor to nominate Maggie Saugstad as our next Eide Effect Hero."
Nominated by John Ulmer Vern Eide



Levi VandenBosch
Detailer
Vern Eide Mitsubishi

"Levi always shows up to work to tackle the day with a positive attitude. He is willing to help everyone with anything. His drive and commitment to Vern Eide make him a hero every day!"

Nominated by Joe Nelson Vern Eide Mitsubishi



Russ Walhof
Service Runner
Vern Eide Honda

"Russ has been a dedicated member of the Eide team for over 50 years, which is an incredible achievement in itself. His commitment and positive attitude embody what it means to live the Eide Effect every single day"

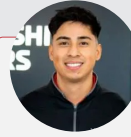
Nominated by Emily Swanger Vern Eide Honda



Bryan Veeder
Sales Manager
Vern Eide Acura

"I'd like to nominate Bryan Veeder. He's humble, kind- an indispensable part of the Acura team. And he has a nice haircut."

Nominated by Josh Heppler Vern Eide Acura



Julian Martinez
Estimator
Vern Eide Mitsubishi

"He always has a huge smile on his face anytime I see him, and it's incredibly contagious to everyone around him. His positive energy, compassion, and dedication make a lasting impact."

Nominated by Jordan Dirkes Vern Eide



Carlos Melgoza Jauregui
Sales Consultant
Vern Eide Honda

"Carlos is always finding ways to help everyone around him—whether it's jumping in to help his teammates in sales or translating for customers in service. Carlos never hesitates to step up when someone needs a hand."
Nominated by Noah Eggebraaten Vern Eide Honda



Zach Bouhamidi
Service Manager
Vern Eide Motoplex

"I've worked closely with Zach and gotten to know him on a professional and personal level. He's a great fit for Motoplex. He's easy to communicate with and is open to new ideas that could benefit the company."
Nominated by Jesse Olson Vern Eide Motoplex



Cindy Pick
Customer Care Representative
Vern Eide Powerhouse

"She's constantly taken the initiative to jump in and help - unpacking orders, rearranging displays, folding clothes over and over, and over again, and assisting customers without hesitation."

Nominated by Leah Hofer Vern Eide Powerhouse



Eide Effect Heroes December 2025

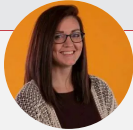


Ron Lunde
Service Runner

Vern Eide
Honda

"I nominate Ron Lunde. Ron has been a dedicated team member for almost 28 years. He's a good mechanic who never calls in sick and is dependable. He is good to his family and has a good, positive attitude."

Nominated by Russ Walhof
Vern Eide Honda



Jessica Reinhart
Senior Graphic Designer

(vvi)

"It's my honor to nominate Jessica Reinhart for the Eide Hero Award. Jess is Vern Eide's incredibly talented graphic designer, and she's truly exceptional at what she does."

Nominated by Maggie Saugstad VVI

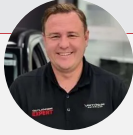


Aaron Clausen
Master Technician

Vern Eide
Acura

"I nominate Aaron Clausen. Over the years, Aaron has helped me many times and always has time for me. I appreciate his help and knowledge. We are lucky to have him on our team."

Nominated by Bryan Veeder
Vern Eide Acura

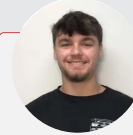


Tyler Swanger
Sales Manager

Vern Eide
Mitsubishi

"I nominate Tyler Swanger. He jokes around with me, and we get along great. He's nice to work with and knows how to have fun. He also lets me clean his cars!"

Nominated by Levi VandenBosch
Vern Eide Mitsubishi



Kaden German
Body Shop Technician

Vern Eide
Body Shop

"I would like to nominate Kaden German. He is a perfect example of an Eide Effect Hero. He makes sure to go the extra mile on every customer's vehicle, even when nobody is watching. Kaden is a great asset to the team."

Nominated by Julian Martinez
Vern Eide Body Shop



Nathan Hoyt
Express Service Advisor

Vern Eide
Honda

"I'd like to nominate Nathan Hoyt for Eide Effect Hero because he's truly one of the most positive and helpful people on our team. No matter how busy things get, Nathan is always willing to jump in and help."

Nominated by Carlos Melgoza Jauregui
Vern Eide Honda



Ashtyn Cobb
Service Administrator

Vern Eide
MOTO V&P PLEX

"She is always willing to help at a moment's notice, and her friendly check-ins with team members greatly boost morale throughout the workplace. Her strong customer service skills and dedication have also led to an impressive return rate on warranty surveys."

Nominated by Zach Bouhamidi
Vern Eide Motoplex



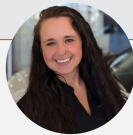
Zach Dybedahl
Sales Manager

Vern Eide
POWERHOUSE

"His encouragement and hands-on support strengthen our sales performance. He brings an exceptional level of energy and positivity to our group. He engages with people in his unique way that shows he cares about what we are doing here."

Nominated by Cindy Pick
Vern Eide Powerhouse

Eide Effect Heroes January 2026

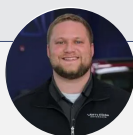


Annika Marquez
Accounting Title Clerk

Vern Eide
Service Center

"What really stands out is how great she is with the sales team—always approachable, helpful, and willing to take the time to answer questions or help work through issues."

Nominated by Tyler Swanger
Vern Eide Mitsubishi

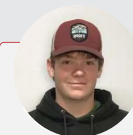


Austin Behnke
Sales Consultant

Vern Eide
Acura

"His deep well of knowledge makes him a go-to resource for solving complex problems, yet he remains remarkably easy to talk to, ensuring that no question feels too small or out of place."

Nominated by Aaron Clausen
Vern Eide Acura



Kale Arthun
Body Shop Technician

Vern Eide
Body Shop

"He starts each day with enthusiasm and a genuine smile, uplifting everyone around them. He approaches challenges with optimism, supports his teammates, and inspires productivity through his encouraging demeanor."

Nominated by Kaden German
Vern Eide Body Shop

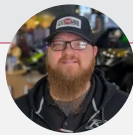


Vincent Price
Express Service Technician

Vern Eide
Honda

"I would like to nominate Vincent Price. I am doing so because he brings the energy and sets the tone every day. One of the best attitudes around and has been killing it ever since he started."

Nominated by Nathan Hoyt
Vern Eide Honda

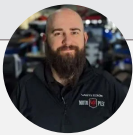


Josh Zuraff
Parts Manager

Vern Eide
MOTO V&P PLEX

"Josh has a great sense of humor and is a good example of the Eide Effect. He is very reliable and many times, without hesitation, is willing to help out in any department"

Nominated by Ashtyn Cobb
Vern Eide Motoplex



Peter Wimmer
Sales Consultant

Vern Eide
POWERHOUSE

"Peter exemplifies Integrity, showing all of his customers Patience, Engagement, and Honesty. Thanks for staying true to yourself, being the nicest, most patient guy in the store, even if we have ...no, get to stay late for every last deal."

Nominated by Zach Dybedahl
Vern Eide Powerhouse



Our Reason Why: To improve the quality of life for our employees, our customers, and our community.

Because you choose to show up every day and do what you do with excellence, we're able to give to non-profit organizations and missions that exist to serve the greater good of our community.

November Donations

Premier Playhouse - Monetary donation supporting their cause to build a community for theatre education and performance helping to nurture artists on stage and also off stage providing classes and partnerships accessible to everyone.

Harmony South Dakota - Monetary donation supporting a free after school music program that provides opportunities for ages 7+ to participate in string orchestra, choir, percussion ensembles, musicianship classes and private instrumental lessons.

Jefferson HS Chorus Boosters - Monetary donation to support their show choir competition

Destiny Youth Ranch - Monetary donation supporting their mission of connecting kids to Jesus.

Children's Advocacy Centers of South Dakota - Monetary donation supporting and providing a safe, friendly place where children who have experienced abuse can share their stories, receive care and begin healing.

Harrisburg Robotics - Monetary donation supporting the student-led robotics team of 4th - 12th graders who are tasked with designing, building and programming robots.

This Is The Way Foundation - Monetary donation to support the foundation providing scholarships for Brandon Valley students pursuing medical degrees, including careers in nursing, medicine, therapy, anesthesiology and more.

Patrick Henry Middle School - Auction item donation raising funds for their Patrick Henry Cares program; raising funds for grocery money and holiday gifts for Patrick Henry Families facing challenges during the holiday season

The Foster Network - Monetary donation supporting foster and kinship families when they say "yes" to caring for children in crisis.

Falls Area Single Track (FAST) - Monetary donation supporting the build of miles of biking/hiking trails near Great Bear

December Donations

Tre Ministries - Monetary donation to support the mission of empowering and equipping young adults to live out their God given purpose and to develop a deeper relationship with God.

Holly Hawk Giving Box - Monetary donation to Hayward Elementary and their Holly Hawk Giving Box fundraiser. Hayward has a 93% poverty rate among their school families. The money raised will go toward purchasing Christmas gifts for the students.

One Leg B4 the Other - Monetary donation to purchase jeans for veterans facing weight changes or hardship, helping restore comfort, dignity and confidence as they transition to civilian life.

January Donations

Premier Playhouse - Monetary donation supporting their cause to build a community for theatre education and performance helping to nurture artists on stage and also off stage providing classes and partnerships accessible to everyone.

Sioux Falls Noon Sertoma Club - Cash donation toward renovating the playground equipment at Sertoma Park to be all inclusive and available for disabled kids.

Washington High School Show Choir - Cash donation toward this artistic event hosting high schoolers from around the area.

Baltic PTO Carnival - Auction donation supporting the PTO providing teacher classroom requests, meals for staff during conferences and playground enhancements.

Sioux Falls Family YMCA Basketball Tournament - Cash donation supporting youth development and making sports and activities accessible to families in need of financial assistance.

Rock Rapids Volunteer Fire Fighters - Auction donation to support the needs of the local, volunteer fire department.

Vern Elde JUMBLED

The Scrambled Word Downside Killed

The letters of these crazy words are jumbled up. Unscramble them to make new words you can use! Use the 12 words below to guess. The correct words will help you solve the final puzzle.

AGS



IHHG



ELSA



Put Answer Here:



WORD HUNT

HRVIUWSDLUVYBUQWZOTRMI
WOWPZIAWARDWINNINGTWP
YUNJIWCLPQVJIOPNBVRZWLA
TWIDVWCIVICFRJQSATNKL RPS
IDWVALIOORWIRIDGELINENVIS
MIQARZIRWQVBIVOTREIWETP
WFASCVDTDXPAPZPYVTWKEIO
DPILOTUWDETZQLCRVCFBHV R
IVERNEIDEHONDAWQTXZVNPT

WORD BANK

HRV Vern Elde Honda GRV Ridgeline Civic
Award Winning Passport Pilot Accord



Scan this QR code to play the
ALL NEW VERDLE! A daily
updating word solving game!
It's like the wordle but for cars!

CROSSWORD

Across

4. Sport known as football outside the U.S.
6. Iconic Roman amphitheater in Italy
9. 26.2 mile race inspired by ancient Greece
10. Figure from Greek myth who held up the sky
12. Company founded by the creator of Mickey Mouse
13. Horse-drawn vehicle of ancient Rome

Down

1. Seafaring Norse explorers and raiders also
2. Four-base hit in baseball
3. Sport with paddles and nets
5. Sport played on ice with sticks and pucks
7. Global multi-sport event with ancient Greek roots
8. German sports car brand
11. Automaker that produces the Model T

